

Tzemach Tzedek Community Centre

Some of the special features of the Nine Days including Tisha b'Av for 5786, shown here for historical purposes only, since we are confidently awaiting the coming of Mashiach.

1. When the month of Av enters, we reduce our joy and minimise any business involvement that leads to joy.
2. Except for the clothes of young children, we don't do any laundry, even if we will not be wearing the clothes until after Tisha b'Av.
3. From Rosh Chodesh, up to and including 15 Menachem Av, it is customary to make or hear a siyum each day.
4. During the Nine Days, we don't eat meat or drink wine, except on Shabbos or at a Seudas Mitzvah.
5. On Erev Shabbos Chazon (Friday 17 July), a person who washes with hot water and/or toivels himself in the mikveh every Friday may wash with hot water without soap (others do permit soap) and toivel himself on this Friday as well.
6. On Shabbos Chazon, the Alter Rebbe would wear all his customary Shabbos clothing, without any deviation from his usual pattern. After Mincha we say the second chapter of Pirkei Avos.
7. On Erev Tisha b'Av (Wednesday 22 July), all the restrictions that apply to Torah study on Tisha b'Av apply from Chatzot Hayom (12:01pm) onwards. We may study only the books of Eichah and Iyov, the unfavourable prophecies in the book of Yirmeyahu, Midrash Eichah and the description of the churban as recorded in the Talmud Maseches Gittin 55b. At Mincha we do not say Tachanun.
8. At the meal before the Fast, we do not eat two cooked dishes. The prevailing custom is to eat a hard-boiled egg dipped in ashes. We do not drink any alcoholic drinks. Eating and drinking must be stopped by the time of Shkia.
9. At Shkia on Wednesday (5:09pm) we remove our leather shoes and put on non-leather footwear. For Maariv we sit on low chairs or cushions. Bring your own to shul. After Maariv we read Megillas Eichah and selected Kinos, then say veAtah Kadosh, a full kaddish, Aleinu and Kiddush Yatom.
10. A person who is sitting shiva (chas v'shalom) may be in shul in the evening and morning until the Kinos are finished, because we are all in mourning on this day.
11. **Tisha b'Av: daytime.** Upon rising from sleep, a person should wash only his fingers, not his entire hand. If he has sleep around his eyes, and he would normally wash it off, he may do so on this occasion as well. We do not say the brocha "she'asah li kal tzarki" until the next morning.
12. We do not greet one another on Tisha b'Av.
13. **Shacharis:** sit on low chair or cushion – bring your own to shul. No tallis or tefillin are worn, and we do not kiss the tzizis of the tallis katan. We say Kinos after the Haftarah. It is customary for each person to say Megillas Eichah individually after Kinos.
14. Until Chatzot Hayom (12:01pm) we don't do any work that involves some time. Similarly we do not sit on regular chairs or prepare food for the evening meal until after Chatzot Hayom.
15. **Before Mincha:** we put on tallis and tefillin and say the appropriate brochos. Then the Shema, shir haYom, Ein Kelokeinu, the portion of Tehillim for the day and any shiurim which normally follow Shacharis. That concludes the omissions made in Shacharis. We then say the korbonos for Mincha, then continue with krias haTorah and Haftarah, followed by Shmonei Esrei etc.
16. We put on Rabbeinu Tam tefillin.
17. **Ending the fast:** We daven Maariv, wash negel vasser, wash our faces and rinse our mouths (no brocha).
18. Make Kiddush Levanah.
19. We can wear leather shoes again.
20. **Breaking the fast of Tisha b'Av:** Refreshments at Tzemach Tzedek after Maariv, with a contribution by Gershon & Yona Gunsberger in honour of those members of their families who died *al kiddush Hashem* during the Shoah, and also in honour of Gershon's alte-zeida Reb Yisroel ben Avraham Kalman haLevi Z"L, whose yahrzeit is on Tisha b'Av.
21. We do not eat meat or drink wine until after Chatzot Hayom on 10 Av (this year at 12:01pm). Similarly the other restrictions of the Nine Days remain in place until after Chatzot Hayom.

Any person who mourns for Yerushalayim will merit to see the celebrations when she is rebuilt. May we merit to greet Mashiach and join with other Yidden at the third Beis haMikdash.

(adapted from the Luach Colel Chabad)